

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J
 ♥ K Q 3
 ♦ Q J 10 9 6 5
 ♣ 7 6

♠ 8 4 3

♥ 9 5

♦ A 7 3

♣ K Q 9 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9 2

♥ A 8 7 4

♦ K 4 2

♣ J 10

♠ 10 7 6 5

♥ J 10 6 2

♦ 8

♣ A 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
2♦	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

First decide about what to do at trick #1. If you hold up and West plays another ♦, no harm will be done. But probably no good will be done either because West is likely to have 6 ♦s, leaving East with just a singleton anyway. But what if West pockets the one ♦ trick and switches to ♥s, a suit where you only have one stopper? Since that might turn out badly, you should **NOT** hold up.

As to which hand to win it in, that's easy. You need to preserve any dummy entries that you can so you win the first trick with your ♦K.

Now you establish some ♣ winners. You play the ♣J and both defenders play low.

You have to assume that defenders good enough to hold up their ♣A at the first opportunity will be good enough to do it on the second play also. But you can thwart them by next playing your ♣10 and overtaking with dummy's ♣Q. Even if they do hold up again you can continue with another ♣ from dummy to establish the suit while you still have the ♦A for an entry.

If you fail to overtake the second ♣ East will hold up the ♣A again.

Then you will lose all those ♣ tricks in dummy.

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When partner bids 3NT AFTER the lebensohl 2NT, he is suggesting you play there, and he guarantees a stopper in their suit. You are happy to pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♦Q. West attacks in ♦s and you must make an immediate choice. Hold up, win in dummy, or win in your hand.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 5

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 6 4

♥ 7 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ Q 8 4 2

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 8 6 2

♦ 7 5 2

♣ K J 9



♠ A Q 8 2

♥ Q 10 9

♦ K 10 4

♣ A 10 6

♠ K J 7

♥ K 5 3

♦ A Q J 8

♣ 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
		1♦	1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♦9. East wins the first trick with the ♦A, then plays ♦Q. You take your ♦K now, fearing that the next one could be ruffed by West.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You hope East, who opened the bidding, (as West before the hands were rotated), will have the ♠K, which would reduce your losers to 4.

You win the second ♦ and play your ♥Q, taken by East with the ♥K. He cashes the ♦J, West following, then exits with a small ♥.

Win this trump and play one more, pulling East's last trump and ending in dummy. Play a ♠ to your ♠Q (which wins) then play ♠A and ruff a ♠ in dummy. East follows with the ♠7, ♠J and ♠K. Now you must try the ♣ finesse, but through whom?

Is it a 50-50 guess? Or is East more likely to have the ♣Q since he had the opening hand?

No, it is not a 50-50 guess. No, East doesn't have the ♣Q, West does. If you watched the cards that East has played you will realize he started with 3-3-4-3 distribution. You will also know that he started with 14 points outside the ♣ suit. If he had the ♣Q he would have a balanced 16 point hand and would have opened 1NT, not 1♦. So West has the ♣Q.

You can go through 100 hands and on 99 of them it won't matter if you pay attention to the cards played by the defenders or not.

But if you don't pay attention on all 100 of them you will miss the one time where your attention was needed.

The question is: Do you use Transfers after a 1NT OVERCALL? And in particular, can you bid the opponent's suit and have it mean a transfer instead of a cue-bid? This is something you and your partner need to agree on - as for me and my partner, we think 2♦ is a transfer. Partner replies 2♥.

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With 10 points you are between Invitational and Game-forcing. Which means you bid either 2NT or 3NT, whichever suits your fancy. Today let's say it is 3NT which partner converts to 4♥.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 2

♥ J 8 6

♦ A 3

♣ J 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5 4

♥ A K 2

♦ Q 4

♣ A K 10 3



♠ A K 9

♥ Q 10 5 4

♦ J 10 9

♣ Q 8 6

♠ 7 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K 8 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♦

All Pass

3♦ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = ? : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 3 + ?

Rather than trying to figure out how many losers this ♦ holding may produce, approach it from the other direction; you can only afford ONE loser, so you assume the cards lie in a way that will give you that result.

That means that the ♦s must be splitting 3-2, and it also means that you must knock out the ♦A without using either the ♦K or ♦Q. Can you do it?

Your only hope is for West to hold a doubleton ♦ A x. You ruff the third ♠, then play a small ♦ toward dummy's ♦ Q. When this wins the trick, play another ♦, and duck in your hand. If West's ♦ A falls you will be golden.

There are times when your only hope of making a contract is if the defender's cards lie in a particular way.

When this happens you should play as if they actually **DO** lie in that way, even though it may be against the percentages.

This hand is a perfect example - your only hope was for West to hold ♦ A x, so - you base your plan on West holding ♦ A x.

In the old days (before transfer bids) you could have just bid a "drop-dead" 2♦. But those days are gone so you must improvise. You bid 2♠, transferring partner to ♣s.

Partner says 3♣;

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Partner says 3♣;

You now bid 3♦ and partner knows to pass.

South plays 3♦. West leads the ♠Q. East overtakes and plays ♠ A K 9.